

openQSE Foundation

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General Foundation Benefits

- A neutral home for the project outside of any one developer/maintainer's organization
- Separation of organizational governance from technical governance
- Protects the intellectual property associated with the project
- Can coordinate to acquire common services (e.g., CI platforms, customer relationship management (CRM) software, etc.)
- Can provide best practices for common needs, such as governance, codes of conduct, roadmapping, hiring practices, licenses, contributing guidelines, etc.
- Can help grow a diverse, skilled workforce in the open source ecosystem

Joint Development Foundation (<https://jointdevelopment.org>)

- Sub-project of the Linux Foundation
- Helps projects advance their standards development process
- Provides governance and legal entity hosting
- Formation documentation templates with standard IP modes
- Helps create a best practices, flexible, consensus-driven development process
- Option to leverage Linux Foundation support capabilities

Benefits of Joining JDF

- Participation in the foundation's network, which includes leaders from a variety of scientifically oriented open source computing communities
- Ability to leverage the foundation's broad, international network to help build connections that support the project
- Ability to create opportunities to connect with another projects as a group to learn lessons and share experiences
- Elevated visibility as a result of the association with the foundation - via the foundation's communications and marketing activities
- Ability to showcase the project to potential funders, including government, philanthropy and industry
- Ability to showcase the project to potential users
- Ability to showcase the project to potential collaborators, possibly leading to a connected ecosystem/stack of coordinated projects
- Help incubate new projects and help them progress, including a possible ramp-down or termination
- Help address security related issues

LF Project Governance Model

Projects follow a governance model that separates business from technical decisions



Funding Options

- **No Sponsorship Fees** is the appropriate selection if you don't intend to finance project activities through a vendor-neutral vehicle
- **Financial Support of the Project** provides fees to join certain membership classes. This option implements a required annual fee at a rate defined in the charter and requires Linux Foundation membership.
- **Alternative or Additional Funding** can be used if the project is grant funded, financially supported by a “parent” Project, or is launching with a single, large sponsorship

Advantages of Funding

- Neutral location for funds
- Support for member meetings - it is strongly recommend that new projects gather their steering and working group participants together within the Project's first year
- Access to program management and/or staff to support operation
- Funds available for essential activities, e.g.:
 - Conformance program development (e.g. collaborating with 3rd party auditors, labs, or setting up other testing infrastructure)
 - Reference implementation development
 - Necessary IT infrastructure / compute
 - Specialized legal services (trademark registration, etc)

Actions

1. Decide fees/no-fees and funding levels*, e.g.
 - a. Steering member: \$30K
 - b. General member: \$5K
 - c. Contributor member: \$0
2. Complete Project Charter
 - a. Determine sponsorship level
 - b. Determine steering committee composition
 - i. Steering member designates a representative
 - ii. Steering committee nominates/votes members to the committee (needs initial committee members)
 - c. Review by participant organizations

* Requires Linux Foundation membership (Silver or Associate level)

Actions

3. Sign membership agreements
4. Sign sponsorship agreements (if financial sponsorship)
5. Create working group charters
 - a. Determine governance model
 - b. Determine copyright and patent licensing models